

is heavy and might sound muddy in some tracks; it holds its own when you tune the buds to your liking and works well in tandem with the mids and the highs produced by the 6mm micro-planar tweeter. You can see that for yourself in the sound signature graph of the CMF Buds 2 Pro.

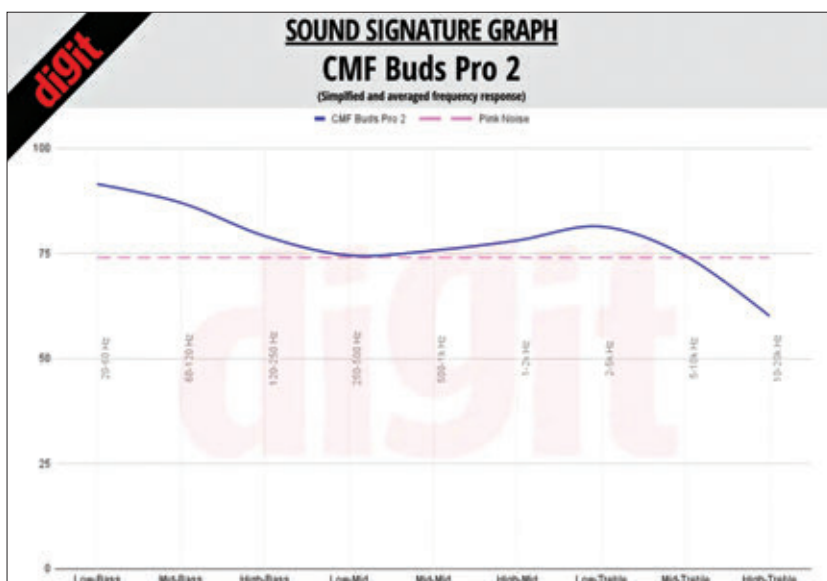
The bass frequencies, up to the 250 Hz mark, are very heavily boosted out of the box, which may be overwhelming for folks who are not big fans of bass-heavy music. The mids do drown out on paper but are fairly perceivable when you are using these in-ear earphones. The highs have a subtle boost, which helps them rise against the bass frequencies, and they register their presence with authority. The sound stage of these earbuds is very intimate until you turn on the 360 spatial audio feature, which blows it wide open. And, thanks to the dual-driver design of these in-ear earphones, you will find above-par layering and separation compared to competitors in the price range. The cherry on the cake is the support for LDAC CODEC, which means you can stream Hi-Res content to these in-ear earphones.

As for the ANC, you get ANC that is on par with what I experienced on the Nothing Ear (1). In fact, these earbuds do remind me a lot of Nothing's first offering in the TWS space. They cancel out background noise effectively and also ensure that droning sounds like those of an AC do not bother you. However, in noisier scenarios, like when the office was buzzing with people's chatter all around me, I had to crank up the volume to around 60 per cent before I could drown out those sounds. And, like many other mid-range offerings, sharp sounds do remain a pain point for these in-ear earphones' ANC.

The microphone on the CMF Buds Pro 2 performed surprisingly well in my test. As you can see in the sample embedded below, my voice was clear, and these in-ear earphones did not pick up a lot of background chatter that was going on in the office. My voice was clear, and I did not sound like a different version of myself.

BATTERY LIFE

Nothing promises 4.3 hours of batter like with ANC on and with LDAC CODEC



being used on the CMF Buds Pro 2. During my time of use, with the same CODEC and ANC setting, and volume set to 50 per cent, I got around 4 hours of continuous playback, which is not the best, but should be fine for most people. With the CODEC switched to AAC, and ANC turned off, you will be able to get much more playback time with these earbuds. You will also get around four more rounds of charging with some battery left in the case, so, you should be able to make it through the day with ease.

And, when you are out of charge, as claimed by Nothing, you can get up to 3 hours of playback on the buds and up to 7 hours with the case after a 10-minute charge, of course, with ANC turned off. Not bad at all. With ANC on, this number will drop to 1.8 hours on the buds and up to 6 hours of playback with the case.

VERDICT

If you are out in the market for a pair of TWS under ₹5,000, then you are set with the CMF Buds Pro 2. With their dual driver setup, which has a lot of potential for the folks who are willing to tinker with the EQ baked into the very well-designed Nothing X app, ANC will serve you well in day-to-day use, and a microphone that is one of the best in this price range in my opinion, fitted into a well-designed package, with a functional dial, and we have a winner. Especially when you factor in their price

tag of ₹4,299. These earbuds are the ones to beat in my opinion under the ₹5,000 mark. Realme Buds Air6 Pro do make a strong case, but their case (no pun intended), has a very polarising design that might not be liked by many. If you are able to get past that, then you have a worthy competitor for the CMF Buds Pro 2.

Another thought that I had with these earbuds is that, they leave very little to be desired, even when you pit them against the pricier Nothing Ear (a). When I reviewed the Nothing Ear (a), I mentioned that those earbuds are the ones for the audiophiles on a budget. However, after spending time with the CMF Buds Pro 2, doubts clouded my mind. If you are a stickler for design, then yes, you might lean towards the Nothing Ear (a). But if you are someone who prefers function over form, then there is not much that would make the case of the Nothing Ear (a) stronger when pitted against the CMF Buds Pro 2.

—Savik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

With Mic: Yes | Wireless range: 10 m | ANC: 50 dB Smart Active Noise Cancellation | Battery Life: 4.3 hrs total | Spatial Audio Effect with Dirac Opteo and LDAC codec combined with Hi-Res Audio | IP Rating: IP55 water resistance

CONTACT

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